Mark Scheme (Pre-Standardisation)

Summer 2026

Pearson Edexcel GCSE
In History (1HI0)
Paper 3: Modern depth study

Option 31: Weimar and Nazi Germany, 1918–39

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General Marking Guidance

- All candidates must receive the same treatment. Examiners must mark the first candidate in exactly the same way as they mark the last.
- Mark schemes should be applied positively. Candidates must be rewarded for what they have shown they can do rather than penalised for omissions.
- Examiners should mark according to the mark scheme not according to their perception of where the grade boundaries may lie.
- There is no ceiling on achievement. All marks on the mark scheme should be used appropriately.
- All the marks on the mark scheme are designed to be awarded. Examiners should always award full marks if deserved, i.e. if the answer matches the mark scheme. Examiners should also be prepared to award zero marks if the candidate's response is not worthy of credit according to the mark scheme.
- Where some judgement is required, mark schemes will provide the principles by which marks will be awarded and exemplification may be limited.
- When examiners are in doubt regarding the application of the mark scheme to a candidate's response, the team leader must be consulted.
- Crossed out work should be marked UNLESS the candidate has replaced it with an alternative response.

How to award marks when level descriptions are used

1. **Finding the right level**

The first stage is to decide which level the answer should be placed in. To do this, use a 'best-fit' approach, deciding which level most closely describes the quality of the answer. Answers can display characteristics from more than one level, and where this happens markers must use the guidance below and their professional judgement to decide which level is most appropriate. For example, one stronger passage at L4 would not by itself merit a L4 mark, but it might be evidence to support a high L3 mark, unless there are substantial weaknesses in other areas. Similarly, an answer that fits best in L3 but which has some characteristics of L2 might be placed at the bottom of L3. An answer displaying some characteristics of L3 and some of L1 might be placed in L2.

2. **Finding a mark within a level**

After a level has been decided on, the next stage is to decide on the mark within the level. The instructions below tell you how to reward responses within a level. However, where a level has specific guidance about how to place an answer within a level, always follow that guidance.

Levels containing two marks only

Start with the presumption that the work will be at the top of the level. Move down to the lower mark if the work only just meets the requirements of the level.

Levels containing three or more marks

Markers should be prepared to use the full range of marks available in a level and not restrict marks to the middle. Markers should start at the middle of the level (or the upper-middle mark if there is an even number of marks) and then move the mark up or down to find the best mark. To do this, they should take into account how far the answer meets the requirements of the level:

- If it meets the requirements *fully*, markers should be prepared to award full marks within the level. The top mark in the level is used for answers that are as good as can realistically be expected within that level.
- If it only *barely* meets the requirements of the level, markers should consider awarding marks at the bottom of the level. The bottom mark in the level is used for answers that are the weakest that can be expected within that level.
- The middle marks of the level are used for answers that have a *reasonable* match to the descriptor. This might represent a balance between some characteristics of the level that are fully met and others that are only barely met.

Indicative content

Examiners are reminded that indicative content is provided as an illustration to markers of some of the material that may be offered by students. It does not show required content and alternatives should be credited where valid.

Modern depth study: Weimar and Nazi Germany, 1918–39

Question	
1	Give **two** things you can infer from Source A about how the Nazi Party dealt with opposition in the years 1933-39. **Target**: Source analysis (making inferences). **AO3**: 4 marks.
Marking instructions	
Award 1 mark for each valid inference up to a maximum of two inferences. The second mark for each example should be awarded for supporting detail selected from the source. e.g. • *The Nazis eliminated potential opposition gradually* ***(1).*** *'First…Then …Then ….'* ***(1).*** • *Various groups of opponents were targeted* ***(1).*** *'the communists… trade unionists …the Jews ….'* ***(1).*** • *Nazis were able to act freely when dealing with opposition* ***(1)****. 'I did not speak out - because I was not ….'* ***(1).*** Accept other appropriate alternatives.	

Question		
2 (a)		Explain why there were changes in the position of women in society in the years 1924-1939. You **may** use the following in your answer: • jobs for women in Weimar Germany • Nazi policies on family You **must** also use information of your own. **Target:** Analysis of second order concepts: causation [AO2]; Knowledge and understanding of features and characteristics [AO1]. **AO2:** 6 marks. **AO1**: 6 marks.
Level	**Mark**	**Descriptor**
	0	No rewardable material.
1	**1–3**	• A simple or generalised answer is given, lacking development and organisation. [AO2] • Limited knowledge and understanding of the topic is shown. [AO1]
2	**4–6**	• An explanation is given, showing limited analysis and with implicit or unsustained links to the conceptual focus of the question. It shows some development and organisation of material, but a line of reasoning is not sustained. [AO2] • Accurate and relevant information is included, showing some knowledge and understanding of the period. [AO1]
3	**7–9**	• An explanation is given, showing some analysis, which is mainly directed at the conceptual focus of the question. It shows a line of reasoning that is generally sustained, although some passages may lack coherence and organisation. [AO2] • Accurate and relevant information is included, showing good knowledge and understanding of the required features or characteristics of the period studied. [AO1] *Maximum 8 marks for answers that do not address three or more aspects of content.*
4	**10–12**	• An analytical explanation is given which is directed consistently at the conceptual focus of the question, showing a line of reasoning that is coherent, sustained and logically structured. [AO2] • Accurate and relevant information is precisely selected to address the question directly, showing wide-ranging knowledge and understanding of the required features or characteristics of the period studied. [AO1] *No access to Level 4 for answers that do not address three or more aspects of content.*

Marking instructions

Markers must apply the descriptors above in line with the general marking guidance (page 3).

Performance in AO1 and AO2 is interdependent. An answer displaying **no** qualities of AO2 cannot be awarded more than the top of Level 1, no matter how strong performance is in AO1; markers should note that the expectation for AO1 is that candidates demonstrate both knowledge *and* understanding.

The middle mark in each level may be achieved by stronger performance in either AO1 or AO2.

Indicative content guidance

Answers must be credited according to candidates' deployment of material in relation to the qualities outlined in the mark scheme. While specific references are made in the indicative content below, this does not imply that these must be included; other relevant material must also be credited.

Relevant points may include:

- The increased opportunities for women to work in Weimar Germany provided financial independence.
- Nazi ideas expected women to focus on their role within the family, so policies were introduced to influence women's clothes, make-up, marriage etc.
- In Nazi Germany, the focus on family meant that new laws were introduced to forbid abortion and contraception, and to make divorce easier.
- Liberal attitudes in Weimar Germany meant that women could express their freedom and independence through their clothes, smoking, socialising, going to nightclubs and participating in politics.
- Nazi policies discouraged women from working, especially in professional roles and married women were usually dismissed from their jobs.
- In 1937, increased demand for workers as a result of rearmament, meant that the Nazis changed the policy on the employment of women and, in 1939, a year of compulsory service in factories or on the land was introduced.

Question		
2 (b)		Explain why Hitler became Chancellor in 1933. You **may** use the following in your answer: • President Hindenburg • elections in 1932 You **must** also use information of your own. **Target:** Analysis of second order concepts: causation [AO2]; Knowledge and understanding of features and characteristics [AO1]. **AO2:** 6 marks. **AO1**: 6 marks.
Level	**Mark**	**Descriptor**
	0	No rewardable material.
1	**1–3**	• A simple or generalised answer is given, lacking development and organisation. [AO2] • Limited knowledge and understanding of the topic is shown. [AO1]
2	**4–6**	• An explanation is given, showing limited analysis and with implicit or unsustained links to the conceptual focus of the question. It shows some development and organisation of material, but a line of reasoning is not sustained. [AO2] • Accurate and relevant information is included, showing some knowledge and understanding of the period. [AO1]
3	**7–9**	• An explanation is given, showing some analysis, which is mainly directed at the conceptual focus of the question. It shows a line of reasoning that is generally sustained, although some passages may lack coherence and organisation. [AO2] • Accurate and relevant information is included, showing good knowledge and understanding of the required features or characteristics of the period studied. [AO1] *Maximum 8 marks for answers that do not address three or more aspects of content.*
4	**10–12**	• An analytical explanation is given which is directed consistently at the conceptual focus of the question, showing a line of reasoning that is coherent, sustained and logically structured. [AO2] • Accurate and relevant information is precisely selected to address the question directly, showing wide-ranging knowledge and understanding of the required features or characteristics of the period studied. [AO1] *No access to Level 4 for answers that do not address three or more aspects of content.*

Marking instructions

Markers must apply the descriptors above in line with the general marking guidance (page 3).

Performance in AO1 and AO2 is interdependent. An answer displaying **no** qualities of AO2 cannot be awarded more than the top of Level 1, no matter how strong performance is in AO1; markers should note that the expectation for AO1 is that candidates demonstrate both knowledge *and* understanding.

The middle mark in each level may be achieved by stronger performance in either AO1 or AO2.

Indicative content guidance

Answers must be credited according to candidates' deployment of material in relation to the qualities outlined in the mark scheme. While specific references are made in the indicative content below, this does not imply that these must be included; other relevant material must also be credited.

Relevant points may include:

- Hitler needed to be appointed Chancellor by President Hindenburg, who had refused to appoint Hitler in 1932 but was persuaded by von Papen to appoint Hitler in January 1933.
- The Nazi Party received the largest number of seats in the Reichstag in the two elections in 1932, so Hitler seemed the person most likely to be able to control the Reichstag.
- Hitler had a high level of public support, as was demonstrated by the presidential elections in 1932, and therefore his appointment would be a popular one.
- The Nazi Party conducted well-planned election campaigns, such as 'Hitler over Germany', which presented Hitler as the one person who could 'save' Germany.
- Von Papen suggested that Hitler could be controlled if the number of Nazis in the cabinet were restricted, so the elite felt that appointing Hitler would not allow the Nazis too much power.
- Hitler promised to attack communism if he were appointed Chancellor, which meant he was viewed favourably by influential businessmen who were alarmed by the threat of communism in the context of the Depression.

Question		
3 (a)		How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into the problems faced by the Weimar Republic in 1923? Explain your answer, using Sources B and C and your knowledge of the historical context. **Target**: Analysis and evaluation of source utility. **AO3**: 8 marks.
Level	**Mark**	**Descriptor**
	0	No rewardable material.
1	**1–2**	• A simple judgement on utility is given, and supported by undeveloped comment on the content of the sources and/or their provenance[1]. Simple comprehension of the source material is shown by the extraction or paraphrase of some content. Limited contextual knowledge is deployed with links to the sources.
2	**3–5**	• Judgements on source utility for the specified enquiry are given, using valid criteria. Judgements are supported by developed comment related to the content of the sources and/or their provenance[1]. Comprehension and some analysis of the sources is shown by the selection and use of material to support comments on their utility. Contextual knowledge is used directly to support comments on the usefulness of the content of the sources and/or their provenance.
3	**6–8**	• Judgements on source utility for the specified enquiry are given, applying valid criteria with developed reasoning which takes into account how the provenance[1] affects the usefulness of the source content. The sources are analysed to support reasoning about their utility. Contextual knowledge is used in the process of interpreting the sources and applying criteria for judgements on their utility.

Notes
1. Provenance = nature, origin, purpose.

Marking instructions

Markers must apply the descriptors above in line with the general marking guidance (page 3).

No credit may be given for contextual knowledge unless it is linked to evaluation of the sources.

No credit may be given for generic comments on provenance which are not used to evaluate source content.

Indicative content guidance

Answers must be credited according to candidates' deployment of material in relation to the qualities outlined in the mark scheme. While specific references are made in the indicative content below, this does not imply that these must be included; other relevant material must also be credited. The grouping of points below does not imply that this is how candidates are expected to structure their answers.

Source B

The usefulness could be identified in terms of the following points which could be drawn from the source:

- The large amount of bank notes being transported implies that the economy of the Weimar Republic had been badly affected by the problem of hyperinflation.
- The photograph shows that hyperinflation meant that businesses and banks needed to have such large quantities of banknotes that they could not be carried by a person.
- The source suggests that individual banknotes printed by the Republic were almost worthless as no-one in the crowd was attempting to seize any of the money.

The following points could be made about the authorship, nature or purpose of the source and applied to ascribe usefulness to material drawn from it:

- The photograph was taken in 1923, when hyperinflation was at its worst.
- As a photograph, the source is a striking image that vividly conveys the problems involved in the Republic continuing to use paper banknotes.

Knowledge of the historical context should be deployed to support inferences and/or to assess the usefulness of information. Relevant points may include:

- Germany had been affected by inflation since the First World War but it escalated to hyperinflation during 1923.
- Hyperinflation was a serious problem for the Weimar Republic because it undermined the people's confidence in the currency.

Source C

The usefulness could be identified in terms of the following points which could be drawn from the source:

- The source indicates Hitler was making a direct attack on the Weimar government.
- The source is useful for suggesting that Hitler believed people were so discontented with the Weimar Republic that they would support his attack.
- The source is useful for suggesting the Weimar Republic might lose control of the army and the police.

The following points could be made about the authorship, nature or purpose of the source and applied to ascribe usefulness to material drawn from it:

- This is a speech designed to convince the people in the beer hall that Hitler could seize power, as he is claiming the Nazis already have achieved the first stages of a putsch.
- Coming from the leader of the Nazis, the speech is useful for showing the intended extent of the challenge to the Weimar Republic.
- As the speech was made in November 1923, it suggests that the Weimar Republic's problems continued throughout the year.

Knowledge of the historical context should be deployed to support inferences and/or to assess the usefulness of information. Relevant points may include:

- Bavaria was the base where the Nazis had the strongest support but was only one area where the authority of the Weimar government was being challenged.
- Hitler and the Nazis attempted a right-wing putsch to overthrow the Weimar Republic but this ultimately failed.

Question		
3 (b)		Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about the problems faced by the Weimar Republic in 1923. What is the main difference between these views? Explain your answer, using details from **both** interpretations. **Target**: Analysis of interpretations (how they differ). **AO4**: 4 marks.
Level	**Mark**	**Descriptor**
	0	No rewardable material.
1	**1–2**	• Limited analysis of the interpretations is shown by the extraction or paraphrase of some content, but differences of surface detail only are given, or a difference of view is asserted without direct support.
2	**3–4**	• The interpretations are analysed and a key difference of view is identified and supported from them.

Marking instructions

Markers must apply the descriptors above in line with the general marking guidance (page 3).

Indicative content guidance

Answers must be credited according to candidates' deployment of material in relation to the qualities outlined in the mark scheme. The indicative content below is not prescriptive and other relevant material not suggested below must also be credited.

- A main difference is that Interpretation 1 suggests that the main problem faced by the Weimar Republic in 1923 was economic difficulties. Interpretation 2, on the other hand, emphasises that political opposition to the Republic was the main problem.

Question		
3 (c)		Suggest **one** reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about the problems faced by the Weimar Republic in 1923. You **may** use Sources B and C to help explain your answer. **Target**: Analysis of interpretations (why they differ). **AO4**: 4 marks.
Level	**Mark**	**Descriptor**
	0	No rewardable material.
1	**1–2**	• A simple valid explanation is offered but displaying only limited analysis. Support for the explanation is based on simple undeveloped comment or on the selection of details from the provided material or own knowledge, with only implied linkage to the explanation.
2	**3–4**	• An explanation of a reason for difference is given, analysing the interpretations. The explanation is substantiated effectively.

Marking instructions

Markers must apply the descriptors above in line with the general marking guidance (page 3).

Indicative content guidance

Answers must be credited according to candidates' deployment of material in relation to the qualities outlined in the mark scheme. The indicative content below is not prescriptive. The examples below show different approaches to explaining difference, any one of which may be valid. Other valid material must be credited.

- The interpretations may differ because the authors have given weight to different sources. For example, Source B shows the effects of inflation and provides some support for Interpretation 1, which explains that hyperinflation was so severe that it weakened the Republic, while Hitler's speech in Source C during the Munich Beer Hall Putsch provides some support for Interpretation 2, which emphasises the extent of political difficulties faced by the Republic.
- The interpretations may differ because the authors are covering different periods within the year 1923; Interpretation 1 covers the early months in 1923, while Interpretation 2 focuses on the later months.
- They may differ because the authors have a different emphasis – Interpretation 1 is dealing with the way that the hyperinflation affected people living in the Weimar Republic; Interpretation 2 is dealing with the political challenges faced by the Weimar government.

Question		
3 (d)		How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about the problems faced by the Weimar Republic in 1923? Explain your answer, using **both** interpretations, and your knowledge of the historical context. **Target**: Analysis and evaluation of interpretations. **AO4**: 16 marks. **Spelling, punctuation, grammar and the use of specialist terminology (SPaG)**: up to 4 additional marks.
Level	**Mark**	**Descriptor**
	0	No rewardable material.
1	**1–4**	• Answer offers simple valid comment to agree with or counter the interpretation. Limited analysis of one interpretation is shown by selection and inclusion of some detail in the form of simple paraphrase or direct quotation. Generalised contextual knowledge is included and linked to the evaluation.
2	**5–8**	• Answer offers valid evaluative comment to agree with or counter the interpretation. Some analysis is shown in selecting and including details from both interpretations to support this comment. Some relevant contextual knowledge is included and linked to the evaluation. An overall judgement is given but its justification is insecure or undeveloped and a line of reasoning is not sustained.
3	**9–12**	• Answer provides an explained evaluation, agreeing or disagreeing with the interpretation. Good analysis of the interpretations is shown indicating difference of view and deploying this to support the evaluation. Relevant contextual knowledge is used directly to support the evaluation. An overall judgement is given with some justification and a line of reasoning is generally sustained.
4	**13–16**	• Answer provides an explained evaluation reviewing the alternative views in coming to a substantiated judgement. Precise analysis of the interpretations is shown, indicating how the differences of view are conveyed and deploying this material to support the evaluation. Relevant contextual knowledge is precisely selected to support the evaluation. An overall judgment is justified and the line of reasoning is coherent, sustained and logically structured.
Marks for SPaG		
Performance	**Mark**	**Descriptor**
	0	• The learner writes nothing. • The learner's response does not relate to the question. • The learner's achievement in SPaG does not reach the threshold performance level, e.g. errors in spelling, punctuation and grammar severely hinder meaning.
Threshold	**1**	• Learners spell and punctuate with reasonable accuracy. • Learners use rules of grammar with some control of meaning and any errors do not significantly hinder meaning overall. • Learners use a limited range of specialist terms as appropriate.
Intermediate	**2–3**	• Learners spell and punctuate with considerable accuracy. • Learners use rules of grammar with general control of meaning overall. • Learners use a good range of specialist terms as appropriate.
High	**4**	• Learners spell and punctuate with consistent accuracy. • Learners use rules of grammar with effective control of meaning overall. • Learners use a wide range of specialist terms as appropriate.

Marking instructions

Markers must apply the descriptors above in line with the general marking guidance (page 3).

No credit may be given for contextual knowledge unless it is linked to evaluation of the interpretations.

In all levels, the second sentence relates to analysis and while the rest relate to evaluation. The following rules will apply:

- In Level 1, answers that meet the requirements only in relation to analysis without evidence of evaluation should be awarded 1 mark.
- In other levels, answers that meet the requirements only in relation to analysis (but that also fully meet the descriptors for evaluation of the level below) should be awarded no more than the bottom mark in the level.

Indicative content guidance

Answers must be credited according to candidates' deployment of material in relation to the qualities outlined in the mark scheme. While specific references are made in the indicative content below, this does not imply that these must be included; other relevant material must also be credited. The grouping of points below does not imply that this is how candidates are expected to structure their answers.

The interpretation to be evaluated suggests that the main problem faced by the Weimar Republic was political opposition.

Relevant points from the provided material and own knowledge which support the claim made in the interpretation may include:

- Interpretation 2 suggests that the political situation was getting worse during 1923.
- Interpretation 2 states that, in November 1923, the Weimar Republic faced an attempted putsch led by Hitler.
- The Weimar Republic was seen as weak from the start - various left-wing and right-wing groups had tried to seize power previously.
- The Weimar government had limited support from a significant proportion of the population as it was blamed for the Versailles Treaty, inflation and the occupation of the Ruhr.
- The system of proportional representation made it difficult for any single party to achieve dominance in the Reichstag, which encouraged extremist groups to attempt to seize power violently, such as in the Munich Putsch.

Relevant points from the provided material and own knowledge which counter the view may include:

- Interpretation 1 suggests that financial difficulties undermined the Republic.
- Interpretation 1 suggests that the government could not deal with the financial problems and the policies such as printing money and calling for passive resistance only made the situation worse.
- The occupation of the Ruhr by French and Belgian troops involved several violent incidents, meaning that foreign relations were an additional problem for the Republic.
- The government delayed taking action to deal with inflation in the hope that the Allies would reconsider the terms of the Treaty of Versailles.
- By the end of 1923, the financial problems were being addressed by the policies of Gustav Stresemann, which meant that the political situation in the Republic began to become more stable.

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